

DIFFERENTIAL GEOMETRY CHAPTER #3

21/04/2026

Q1: A point P on a surface is called hyperbolic if the gaussian curvature K at P is negative. This means that the two principle curvatures have opposite signs.

An asymptotic direction is a dir at a point P is a direction vector v for which $K_n = 0$. (K_n is the normal curvature).

The normal curvature $K(v)$ in any direction v can be expressed using Euler's formula:

$$K_n(v) = k_1 \cos^2 \theta + k_2 \sin^2 \theta$$

For an asymptotic direction, $k_1 \cos^2 \theta + k_2 \sin^2 \theta = 0$

$$k_1 \cos^2 \theta = -k_2 \sin^2 \theta \quad (\text{dividing b/s by } \cos^2 \theta \text{ since } \cos \theta \neq 0 \text{ as } \theta = \frac{\pi}{2} \text{ means } k_2 = 0 \text{ which is not true for a}$$

$$\tan^2 \theta = -\frac{k_1}{k_2} \quad \text{hyperbolic point} \quad \tan^2 \theta = m^2 \Leftrightarrow \theta = \arctan(m) \text{ or } \theta_2 = -\arctan(m)$$

The principal directions are orthogonal to each other (e_1 and e_2). The angle between e_1 and first asymptotic direction is θ_1 . The angle between e_1 and second asymptotic direction is θ_2 .

Now consider the second principal direction e_2 . The angle between e_2 and first asymptotic direction is $|\frac{\pi}{2} - \theta_1|$. The angle between e_2 and second asymptotic direction is $|\frac{\pi}{2} - (-\theta_1)| = |\frac{\pi}{2} + \theta_1|$.

For the principle directions to bisect the asymptotic directions, each principle direction must lie on the angle bisector of the two asymptotic direction.

- The asymptotic directions are at angle θ_1 & $-\theta_1$ relative to e_1 .
- The asymptotic directions are at angle $|\frac{\pi}{2} - \theta_1|$ & $|\frac{\pi}{2} + \theta_1|$ relative to e_2 .

Q2: Let C be a curve in S such that, for every point in C , such that S is tangent to a plane T . Let us consider $\alpha: (-\epsilon, \epsilon) \rightarrow C \subset S$ a regular parametrisation of C such that $\alpha(0) = p \in S$, $\alpha'(0) = N \in T_p S$. Since S is tangent to the plane T at every $\alpha(t) \in C$,

$$N(t) = (N \circ \alpha)(t) = N_0 \quad \forall t \in (-\epsilon, \epsilon)$$

$$\text{So } N'(t) = dN_{\alpha(t)}(\alpha'(t)) = 0 \quad \forall t \in (-\epsilon, \epsilon)$$

$$dN_p(v) = 0 = 0v \Rightarrow k_1 = 0 \text{ or } k_2 = 0 \Rightarrow \det(dN_p) = 0 \text{ so it is}$$

either parabolic or planar
 $dN_p = 0$

3. We know the normal curvature is given by:

$$k_n = k \langle n, n \rangle = k \cos \theta \Rightarrow |k_n| \leq |k|$$

$$k = |k|$$

$$\pm k_1 \cos^2 \theta \pm k_2 \sin^2 \theta \leq k$$

$$|k_1| \cos^2 \theta + |k_2| \sin^2 \theta \leq k$$

$$k \geq \{\min(|k_1|, |k_2|)\} (\cos^2 \theta + \sin^2 \theta)$$

$$k \geq \min\{|k_1|, |k_2|\}$$

Q4. Let's consider a circle on a plane P . At P , we have $k_1 = k_2 = 0$ which satisfies $|k_1| \leq 1$ & $|k_2| \leq 1$. This circle is a closed curve on S such that curvature $k = \frac{1}{r}$ which is > 1 for $r < 1$ which does not satisfy $|k| \leq 1$

Q5. $H = \frac{k_1 + k_2}{2}$ & $k_n = k_1 \cos^2 \theta + k_2 \sin^2 \theta$

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^\pi k_n d\theta &= \int_0^\pi (k_1 \cos^2 \theta + k_2 \sin^2 \theta) d\theta = \frac{k_1}{2} \int_0^\pi (1 + \cos 2\theta) d\theta + \frac{k_2}{2} \int_0^\pi (1 - \cos 2\theta) d\theta \\ &= \frac{k_1}{2} \left(\theta + \frac{\sin(2\theta)}{2} \right) + \frac{k_2}{2} \left(\theta - \frac{\sin(2\theta)}{2} \right) \Big|_0^\pi \\ &= \frac{k_1}{2} \left(\pi + \frac{\sin(2\pi)}{2} \right) + \frac{k_2}{2} \left(\pi - \frac{\sin(2\pi)}{2} \right) \\ &= \frac{k_1}{2} \pi + \frac{k_2}{2} \pi = \frac{1}{2} (k_1 \pi + k_2 \pi) = \pi H \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{so } H = \frac{1}{\pi} \int_0^\pi k_n d\theta$$

Since θ is an angle that corresponds to some direction, it follows for instance that $\theta + \frac{\pi}{2}$ is perpendicular to the original direction determined by θ .

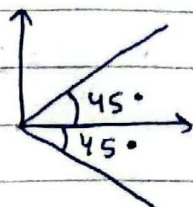
$$\begin{aligned} k_n(\theta + \frac{\pi}{2}) &= k_1 \cos^2(\theta + \frac{\pi}{2}) + k_2 \sin^2(\theta + \frac{\pi}{2}) \\ &= k_1 (-\sin(\theta))^2 + k_2 (\cos(\theta))^2 \\ &= k_1 \sin^2 \theta + k_2 \cos^2 \theta \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} k_n(\theta) + k_n(\theta + \frac{\pi}{2}) &= k_1 \cos^2 \theta + k_2 \sin^2 \theta + k_1 \sin^2 \theta + k_2 \cos^2 \theta \\ &= k_1 + k_2 \text{ which does not depend on } \theta. \end{aligned}$$

Q7 For a mean curvature to be zero, $H = \frac{k_1 + k_2}{2} = 0 \Rightarrow k_1 = -k_2$

$$k = k_1, k_2 = -k_2^2 \leq 0$$

$$k_n(\theta) = 0 \Rightarrow k_1 \cos^2 \theta = k_1 \sin^2 \theta \Leftrightarrow \sin(\theta) = \pm \cos(\theta) \Rightarrow \theta = \frac{\pi}{4} \text{ or } \theta = \frac{3\pi}{4}$$



Q8 (a) $z = x^2 + y^2$; $f(x, y, z) = x^2 + y^2 - z^2$; $S = \{(x, y, z) \in \mathbb{R}^3; f(x, y, z) = 0\}$

$$N(x, y, z) = \frac{\nabla f}{|\nabla f|} = \frac{(2x, 2y, -1)}{\sqrt{4(x^2 + y^2) + 1}}$$

(b) $x^2 + y^2 - z^2 = 1$; $S = \{(x, y, z) \in \mathbb{R}^3; f(x, y, z) = 0\}$ $f(x, y, z) = x^2 + y^2 - z^2 - 1$

$$N(x, y, z) = \frac{\nabla f}{|\nabla f|} = \frac{(2x, 2y, -2z)}{\sqrt{4(x^2 + y^2 + z^2) + 4}}$$

$$(c) N(x, y, z) = \frac{\nabla f}{|\nabla f|} = \frac{(2x, 2y, -2 \cosh(z) \sinh(z))}{\sqrt{4(x^2 + y^2 + \cosh^2(z) \sinh^2(z))}}$$

Q9

(a) Let's assume for the sake of contradiction that the spherical image $N \circ \alpha$ is not a regular curve on S^2 .

For a curve to not be regular its tangent vectors must be zero at some point. So, there must exist a time t_0 for which derivative of spherical image equals zero; $(N \circ \alpha)'(t_0) = 0$

$$(N \circ \alpha)'(t_0) = 0 \Rightarrow dN_{\alpha(t_0)}(\alpha'(t_0)) = 0$$

That means there is a non-trivial $\alpha'(t_0) \neq 0$ such that $\alpha'(t_0) \in \ker dN$ which means that the null space of dN is non-empty and hence $\det(dN) = 0$ so $k_1, k_2 = 0$ which means it must contain planar ($k_1 = k_2 = 0$) or parabolic (k one zero, other non-zero).

Therefore we reach a contradiction as we had no planar or parabolic points in the original statements. So, therefore, at all points $\alpha(t)$ both principal curvatures are non-zero.

b) Consider the parametrization of a curve α by arc length s . Let $\beta = N\alpha$ be the spherical image of C . Since C is line of curvature, it follows that $\beta'(s) = dN\left(\frac{d\alpha}{ds}\right) = \lambda(s)\alpha'(s) \quad \forall s \in I$

$$\beta''(s) = \lambda'(s)\alpha'(s) + \lambda(s)\alpha''(s)$$

$$k_N(s) = \frac{|\beta'(s) \wedge \beta''(s)|}{|\beta'(s)|^3} = \frac{|\lambda(s)|^2 |\alpha'(s) \wedge \alpha''(s)|}{|\lambda(s)|^3 |\alpha'(s)|^3} \quad |\alpha'(s)| = 1$$

$$= \frac{1}{|\lambda(s)|} |\alpha'(s) \wedge \alpha''(s)| = \frac{k(s)}{|\lambda(s)|}$$

$$k_N(\alpha'(s)) = \text{II}_{\alpha(s)}(\alpha'(s)) = -\langle dN_{\alpha(s)}(\alpha'(s)), \alpha'(s) \rangle = -\lambda(s) \langle \alpha'(s), \alpha'(s) \rangle = -\lambda(s)$$

$$|k_N \alpha'(s)| = |\lambda(s)|$$

$$k = |\lambda| k_N = |k_N| k_N = |k_N| k_N$$

Q10: Let $C = \alpha(I)$ be a line of curvature on the surface S . $\alpha(s)$ is parametrized by arc length so $|\alpha'(s)| = 1$. Also $dN_{\alpha(s)}(\alpha'(s)) = \lambda(s)\alpha'(s) \quad \forall s \in I$.

If α is a line of curvature it's tangent $t(s) = \alpha'(s)$ is an eigenvector of the shape operator dN_p .

Since C is nowhere tangent to an asymptotic direction, normal curvature k_n of S along $t(s)$ is never zero. The angle spanned by the plane of C (spanned by $t(s)$ and $n(s)$) and the tangent plane of S is ~~not~~ constant.

The angle between two planes is determined by the angle between their normal vectors.

Normal vector to C is the osculating plane & tangent plane to S at $\alpha(s)$ is $T_{\alpha(s)}S$.

$$\cos \theta = \frac{\langle b(s), N(\alpha(s)) \rangle}{|b(s)| |N(\alpha(s))|} = \text{constant} \rightarrow \langle b(s), N(\alpha(s)) \rangle = \text{constant}$$

$$\text{differentiating b.c.: } \langle b'(s), N(\alpha(s)) \rangle + \langle b(s), dN_{\alpha(s)}(\alpha'(s)) \rangle = 0$$

$$\Leftrightarrow \langle \tau(s)n(s), N(\alpha(s)) \rangle + \langle b(s), \lambda(s)\alpha'(s) \rangle = 0$$

$$\Leftrightarrow \tau(s) \langle n(s), N(\alpha(s)) \rangle = 0 \Leftrightarrow \tau(s) = 0$$

Why can't $\langle n(s), N(\alpha(s)) \rangle = 0$? Since C lies on a tangent to an asymptotic line, $k_n \neq 0 \quad \forall s \in I$.

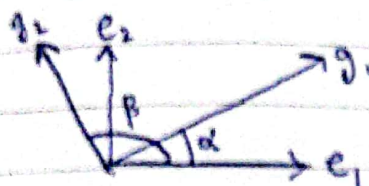
$$k_1 |r'(s)| = k(s) < n(s), N(u(s)) > +0 \forall s \in I. \Rightarrow \langle n(s), N(u(s)) \rangle > +0$$

Q. if r and r' are conjugates, then we know any conjugates of r and r' are also conjugates. Consider: ① $g_1 = e_1 \cos(\alpha) + e_2 \sin(\alpha) \in r$

$$② g_2 = e_1 \cos(\beta) + e_2 \sin(\beta) \in r'$$

$$\langle N_T(g_1), g_2 \rangle = 0 \Leftrightarrow -k_1 \cos \alpha \cos \beta - k_2 \sin \alpha \sin \beta = 0$$

$$\Leftrightarrow \tan \alpha \tan \beta = -\frac{k_1}{k_2} \quad (\text{for } \alpha, \beta \neq \frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{3\pi}{2})$$



Angle between g_1 & g_2 is $\beta - \alpha$.

$$\tan(\beta - \alpha) = \frac{\tan(\beta) - \tan(\alpha)}{1 + \tan(\beta)\tan(\alpha)} = \frac{-\frac{k_1}{k_2} \cot(\alpha) - \tan(\alpha)}{1 - \frac{k_1}{k_2}}$$

$$= \frac{1}{1 - \frac{k_1}{k_2}} \left[\frac{-k_1 \cot(\alpha) - \tan(\alpha)}{k_2} \right]$$

differentiating ^{right side} ~~left~~ for minimum:

$$\frac{1}{1 - \frac{k_1}{k_2}} \left[\frac{-k_1}{k_2} (-\csc^2(\alpha)) - \sec^2(\alpha) \right] = 0$$

$$\Leftrightarrow \frac{k_1}{k_2} \csc^2(\alpha) - \sec^2(\alpha) = 0$$

$$\Leftrightarrow \frac{k_1}{k_2} \left[\frac{1}{\sin^2(\alpha)} \right] - \frac{1}{\cos^2(\alpha)} = 0$$

$$\tan^2(\alpha) = \frac{k_1}{k_2} \quad \Leftrightarrow \tan(\alpha) = \pm \sqrt{\frac{k_1}{k_2}}$$

$$\tan \beta = \frac{-k_1}{k_2} \bigg/ \pm \sqrt{\frac{k_1}{k_2}} = \mp \sqrt{\frac{k_1}{k_2}}$$

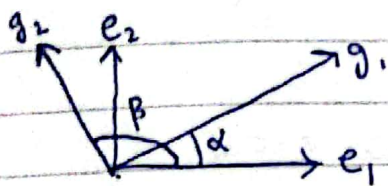
$$|k_n| \alpha'(s)| = k(s) \langle n(s), N(\alpha(s)) \rangle \neq 0 \quad \forall s \in I. \Rightarrow \langle n(s), N(\alpha(s)) \rangle \neq 0$$

Q11 if r and r' are conjugates, then we know any conjugates of r and r' are also conjugates. Consider: ① $g_1 = e_1 \cos(\alpha) + e_2 \sin(\alpha) \in r$

$$② g_2 = e_1 \cos(\beta) + e_2 \sin(\beta) \in r'$$

$$\langle dN_p(g_1), g_2 \rangle = 0 \Leftrightarrow -k_1 \cos \alpha \cos \beta - k_2 \sin \alpha \sin \beta = 0$$

$$\Leftrightarrow \tan \alpha \tan \beta = -\frac{k_1}{k_2} \quad \left(\text{for } \alpha, \beta \neq \frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{3\pi}{2} \right)$$



Angle between g_1 & g_2 is $\beta - \alpha$.

$$\tan(\beta - \alpha) = \frac{\tan(\beta) - \tan(\alpha)}{1 + \tan(\beta)\tan(\alpha)} = \frac{-\frac{k_1}{k_2} \cot(\alpha) - \tan(\alpha)}{1 - \frac{k_1}{k_2}}$$

$$= \frac{1}{1 - \frac{k_1}{k_2}} \left[\frac{-k_1 \cot(\alpha) - \tan(\alpha)}{k_2} \right]$$

differentiating ~~right~~ side for minimum:

$$\frac{1}{1 - \frac{k_1}{k_2}} \left[\frac{-k_1}{k_2} (-\operatorname{cosec}^2(\alpha)) - \sec^2(\alpha) \right] = 0$$

$$\Leftrightarrow \frac{k_1}{k_2} \operatorname{cosec}^2(\alpha) - \sec^2(\alpha) = 0$$

$$\Leftrightarrow \frac{k_1}{k_2} \left[\frac{1}{\sin^2(\alpha)} \right] - \frac{1}{\cos^2(\alpha)} = 0$$

$$\tan^2(\alpha) = \frac{k_1}{k_2} \Leftrightarrow \tan(\alpha) = \pm \sqrt{\frac{k_1}{k_2}}$$

$$\tan \beta = \frac{-k_1}{k_2} \bigg/ \pm \sqrt{\frac{k_1}{k_2}} = \mp \sqrt{\frac{k_1}{k_2}}$$

Let c be the asymptotic curve and $\alpha: I \rightarrow c$ be a parametrisation by arc length. ~~we have $0 = k_n(\alpha'(s)) = k_1 \cos^2 \theta_s + k_2 \sin^2 \theta_s$~~

13: $0 = k_n(\alpha'(s)) = k_1 \cos^2 \theta_s + k_2 \sin^2 \theta_s, \forall s \in I$, where k_1 & k_2 are the principal curvatures and θ is the angle between $\alpha'(s)$ & e_1 , we have $k_1 \cos^2 \theta_s = -k_2 \sin^2 \theta_s, \forall s \in I$

$$N'(s) = dN_{\alpha(s)}(\alpha'(s)) = dN_{\alpha(s)}(e_1 \cos \theta_s + e_2 \sin \theta_s) \\ = \cos \theta_s dN_{\alpha(s)}(e_1) + \sin \theta_s dN_{\alpha(s)}(e_2) = -k_1 \cos \theta_s e_1 - k_2 \sin \theta_s e_2$$

$$\|N'(s)\|^2 = k_1^2 \cos^2 \theta_s + k_2^2 \sin^2 \theta_s, \forall s \in I$$

$$\langle N(s), \alpha'(s) \rangle = 0 \Leftrightarrow \langle N'(s), \alpha'(s) \rangle + \langle N(s), \alpha''(s) \rangle = 0$$

$$\langle N(s), \alpha''(s) \rangle = 0 \Rightarrow -\langle dN_{\alpha(s)}(\alpha'(s)), \alpha'(s) \rangle \\ = -\text{II}_{\alpha(s)}(\alpha'(s)) = k_n(\alpha'(s)) = 0$$

$$\langle N(s), \alpha''(s) \rangle = 0 \Rightarrow k(s) \langle N(s), n(s) \rangle = 0, \forall s \in I$$

$$N(s) \perp n(s) \nmid N(s) \perp \alpha'(s)$$

$$\text{So } N(s) = \pm b(s) = \pm J(s)n(s)$$

$$\|N'(s)\| = |J(s)| \|n(s)\| = |J(s)| \Rightarrow \|N'(s)\|^2 = |J(s)|^2$$

$$|J(s)|^2 = k_1 \cos^2 \theta + k_2 \sin^2 \theta \Rightarrow k_1 (-k_2 \sin^2 \theta) + k_2 (-k_1 \cos^2 \theta) = |J(s)|^2$$

$$-k_1 k_2 (\sin^2 \theta + \cos^2 \theta) = |J(s)|^2$$

$$|J(s)|^2 = -K \Rightarrow |J(s)|^2 = -k_1 k_2 = -K \Rightarrow |J(s)| = \sqrt{-K} \forall s \in I$$

14: